

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Project Documentation & Implementation Report

TEAM & PARTICIPANT DETAILS

Team ID:	SWTID-2026-9791
Team Size:	3 Members
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Problem Statement & Project Objective

Problem Statement: The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests often require configuration steps that are prone to oversight or delay, leading to user frustration and inefficient IT resource allocation.

Project Objective: Implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops, ensuring timely configuration, reduced manual intervention, optimized resource allocation, and enhanced overall operational productivity.

Step-by-Step Implementation Guide

Milestone 1: Flow Creation

1. Open ServiceNow, search for **Flow Designer** under Process Automation, click **New**, and select **Flow**.
2. Configure Flow Properties: Give Flow Name as **Standard Laptop task**, Application as **Global**, and Run As **System User**. Click **Submit**.
3. Click **Add a trigger**, search for and select **Service Catalog**, then click **Done**.
4. Under Actions, add the **Create Catalog Task** action.
5. Drag and drop the Requested Item Record into Request item. The Table will be auto-populated as **Catalog Task [sc_task]**.
6. Set Short description and Description as **Laptop needs to Configured**.
7. Set Assignment group field value to **Hardware** and Approval field value to **Approved**. Click **Done**.
8. Save the Flow and click **Activate**.

Milestone 2: Flow Assignment

1. Open ServiceNow and search for **Maintain Items**. Select the Maintain Items module.
2. Search for and select the **Standard Laptop** record under the Name field.
3. Navigate to the **Process Engine** tab, remove existing legacy automations, and select the newly created flow **Standard Laptop task**.
4. Click the menu options and save the record.

Milestone 3: Service Catalog Ordering and Verification

1. Search for **Service Catalog**, navigate to **Hardware**, and click on **Standard Laptop**.
2. Click **Order Now** to place the request, then click on the generated Request Number (e.g., REQ0010001) from the order status screen.
3. Scroll down to the **Approvers** section, right-click the approver record, and select **Approve**.
4. Navigate to the Requested Item section (RITM0010001) and scroll down to the **Catalog Tasks** section to verify that the task (SCTASK0010001) is automatically created, assigned to the **Hardware** group with the configured short description.

Conclusion

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses operational inefficiencies and eliminates manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures prompt configuration of laptops upon approval, minimizes user wait times, optimizes resource allocation, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department.